



S.E. Thurston Fire Authority

REQUEST FOR QUALIFICATIONS

ARCHITECTURAL AND ENGINEERING SERVICES

Publication Date: September 14, 2026

Closing Date and Time: 5:00 PM Pacific Time, October 30, 2026

NOTICE

Pursuant to Chapter 39.80 RCW, notice is hereby given that the **Southeast Thurston Fire Authority (SETFA)** is soliciting Statements of Qualifications from qualified architectural and engineering firms to provide professional architectural and engineering services for facility improvements anticipated over the next year or more.

All firms legally qualified to practice the applicable architectural and engineering professions are encouraged to submit their Statements of Qualifications and relevant performance information in accordance with the requirements of this Request for Qualifications (RFQ).

SETFA intends to select the firm it determines to be the most highly qualified to provide the requested professional services and may negotiate a professional services agreement with the selected firm.

1. BACKGROUND

The Southeast Thurston Fire Authority (SETFA) was established in 2010 and provides fire suppression, rescue, emergency medical, and related emergency services to more than 30,000 residents in Southeast Thurston County, Washington.

SETFA provides services to the suburban communities of **Yelm and Rainier**, as well as surrounding rural areas.

SETFA intends to utilize general obligation bond proceeds, impact fees, state-granted capital project funds, and other available funding sources to implement its facility improvement plan.

SETFA has completed preliminary design and planning work that has helped establish desired project outcomes and priorities. SETFA is now seeking a qualified architectural and engineering firm to provide professional services necessary to further develop, document, permit, bid, and administer construction for the identified facility improvements.



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2. PROJECT OVERVIEW AND ORDER OF PRIORITY

SETFA anticipates professional architectural and engineering services for the following facility improvement projects. Projects are listed in the anticipated order of priority; however, SETFA reserves the right to modify the order, scope, schedule, or sequencing of projects based on available funding, operational needs, permitting requirements, or other considerations.

Priority 1 — Station 22: Lake Lawrence Fire Station

Location: 17213 153rd Avenue SE, Yelm, WA 98597

Remodel and addition to the existing Lake Lawrence Fire Station, including associated site, architectural, structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, civil, and other improvements as determined necessary.

Priority 2 — Station 24: Rainier Station

Location: 12506 133rd Avenue SE, Rainier, WA 98576

Remodel and addition to the existing Rainier Station, including associated site, architectural, structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, civil, and other improvements as determined necessary.

Priority 3 — Station 21: Yelm Station

Location: 709 Mill Road, Yelm, WA 98597

Remodel and addition to the existing Yelm Station, including associated site, architectural, structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, civil, and other improvements as determined necessary.

Priority 4 — Station 25: Macintosh Station

Location: 14827 Military Road, Tenino, WA 98589

Relocation of the current Manufactured home at the Rainier Station to the Macintosh station. Bay extension and light remodel to the apparatus building at Macintosh.

SETFA may elect to proceed with one or more projects independently or concurrently. The selected firm should demonstrate the capacity to manage multiple projects and phases, if requested by SETFA.



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3. SCOPE OF SERVICES

The selected firm shall provide all architectural and engineering design services, project management, coordination, and related professional services necessary to produce complete, comprehensive, biddable, permit-ready, and construction-ready documents for the identified projects.

The scope shall include, but is not necessarily limited to, the following:

3.1 General Requirements

The selected firm shall:

- Conduct site investigations, analysis, and verification of existing conditions.
- Review available existing plans, surveys, studies, and preliminary design information provided by SETFA.
- Identify existing conditions, deficiencies, and project requirements affecting design and construction.
- Obtain or coordinate all applicable permits and approvals.
- Ensure compliance with applicable federal, state, and local laws, codes, regulations, and standards.
- Coordinate all required specialty consultants, including, as applicable, civil, structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, environmental, geotechnical, fire protection, energy, telecommunications, and other specialty consultants.
- Coordinate the work of all disciplines to provide a complete and coordinated design.
- Attend regular project meetings with SETFA representatives.
- Maintain regular communication with SETFA throughout the project.
- Provide project scheduling and coordination services.
- Develop and maintain project cost estimates throughout the design process.
- Identify potential project risks, cost concerns, schedule impacts, and other issues in a timely manner.
- Provide other professional services reasonably necessary to complete the projects.



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4. ARCHITECTURAL DESIGN PHASES

The selected firm will be expected to provide professional services through the following standard architectural and engineering phases, as applicable.

4.1 Schematic Design

Services shall include, but are not limited to:

- Update and/or develop site and building plans based on the project requirements.
- Evaluate existing facilities and site conditions.
- Develop preliminary design concepts and alternatives, as appropriate.
- Establish preliminary building systems and material selections.
- Coordinate preliminary architectural and engineering concepts.
- Identify applicable permitting and code requirements.
- Prepare a preliminary statement of probable construction cost.
- Review the preliminary design with SETFA and incorporate approved direction.

4.2 Design Development

Services shall include, but are not limited to:

- Develop detailed floor plans, elevations, sections, and typical construction details.
- Further develop architectural and engineering systems.
- Coordinate structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, civil, and other engineering disciplines.
- Develop material and equipment selections.
- Identify major building systems and construction requirements.
- Coordinate project requirements with SETFA representatives.
- Update the probable construction cost.
- Identify significant design, budget, or schedule issues requiring SETFA direction.

4.3 Construction Documents

Services shall include, but are not limited to:

- Prepare complete construction drawings and specifications.
- Develop detailed plans, schedules, details, elevations, sections, and other documentation necessary for construction.
- Incorporate appropriate structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, civil, and specialty engineering documents.
- Prepare specifications identifying required materials, equipment, systems, workmanship, and quality standards.



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- Prepare documents suitable for competitive bidding, permitting, and construction.
 - Submit documents to applicable permitting authorities and respond to plan review comments.
 - Update the probable construction cost.
 - Provide final signed and sealed construction documents.
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5. BIDDING AND NEGOTIATIONS ASSISTANCE

The selected firm shall assist SETFA during the bidding and procurement process, including, as applicable:

- Assist SETFA in obtaining competitive bids or proposals.
 - Respond to bidder questions and requests for clarification..
 - Assist SETFA in evaluating bids and proposals.
 - Provide recommendations regarding the responsiveness and qualifications of bidders, as requested.
 - Assist SETFA with construction contract award.
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6. CONSTRUCTION ADMINISTRATION

The selected firm shall provide construction administration services as requested by SETFA, including, but not limited to:

- Represent SETFA during the construction phase.
- Attend construction meetings as appropriate.
- Conduct site visits at appropriate intervals during construction.
- Observe construction progress and report significant observations to SETFA.
- Review contractor submittals, including shop drawings, product data, samples, and other required submissions.
- Respond to requests for information and requests for clarification.
- Assist with interpretation and clarification of the construction documents.
- Review contractor payment applications in conjunction with completed work.
- Prepare and/or review change orders when necessary.
- Assist SETFA with evaluation of proposed changes to the work.
- Conduct substantial completion and final completion inspections.
- Prepare or assist with punch lists.
- Assist SETFA with final project closeout and turnover.



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7. DELIVERABLES

The selected firm shall provide deliverables appropriate to each phase of the project. Deliverables shall include, but are not limited to:

- Digital and printed sets of drawings.
- Digital and printed sets of specifications.
- Updated statements of probable construction cost.
- Permit and agency submittals.
- Bid and procurement documents.
- Addenda, as applicable.
- Construction administration documentation.
- Project closeout documentation.
- Final signed and sealed construction documents.

SETFA will establish the required electronic file formats and number of printed sets with the selected firm during contract negotiations.

8. FIRM QUALIFICATIONS AND STATEMENT OF QUALIFICATIONS

Interested firms shall submit a Statement of Qualifications demonstrating their ability to successfully provide the requested professional services.

Submittals should include, at a minimum, the following information:

8.1 Firm Information

- Legal company name.
- Business address.
- Telephone number.
- Website.
- Year established.
- Brief history of the firm.
- Organizational structure and ownership.
- Relevant professional registrations and licenses.
- Identify if the Firm has been involved in any claims, litigation or arbitration and or ever filed bankruptcy



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8.2 Primary Contact

Identify the individual who will serve as the firm's primary contact for this RFQ, including:

- Name and title.
- Email address.
- Telephone number.

8.3 Relevant Experience

Provide a summary of projects demonstrating experience relevant to SETFA's needs, with particular emphasis on:

- Fire station projects.
- Public-sector facilities.
- Projects involving phased construction.
- Projects with similar size, scope, complexity, and operational requirements.

For each relevant project, provide, to the extent applicable:

- Project name.
- Project location.
- Brief description of services provided.
- Completion date.
- Client contact name and contact information.
- Any applicable reference

8.4 Proposed Project Team

Identify the key personnel proposed for the SETFA project and describe:

- Qualifications and professional experience.
- Relevant fire station and public-sector project experience.
- Proposed role and responsibilities.
- Length of time proposed team members have worked together.

8.5 Project Approach

Describe the firm's anticipated approach to the SETFA facility improvement program.

The response should demonstrate an understanding of:

- SETFA's operational requirements.



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- Fire station design and emergency response considerations.
- Remodeling and expanding existing facilities.
- Budget and schedule management.
- Coordination among multiple disciplines and consultants.
- Permitting and regulatory requirements.
- Stakeholder communication.
- Construction administration.

8.6 Budget and Schedule Management

Describe the firm's approach and demonstrated success in:

- Maintaining projects within established budgets.
- Developing and updating reliable construction cost estimates.
- Managing project schedules.
- Identifying and mitigating cost and schedule risks.

9. SELECTION PROCESS

SETFA will evaluate Statements of Qualifications and may interview two or three firms determined to be most qualified.

SETFA intends to select the firm determined to be the most highly qualified to provide the requested professional services. The selection process may include, but is not limited to, consideration of the following criteria:

1. **Relevant Experience**
Length and depth of experience providing architectural and engineering services for similar projects.
2. **Fire Station Experience**
Demonstrated experience designing, remodeling, and/or expanding fire stations and emergency service facilities.
3. **Relevant Project Experience**
Quality and relevance of comparable projects, including project complexity, size, scope, and construction cost.
4. **Project Team Qualifications**
Qualifications and experience of the proposed project team, including the team's demonstrated ability to work together effectively.
5. **Budget and Schedule Performance**
Demonstrated ability to successfully manage project budgets and schedules.



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6. **Understanding of SETFA's Needs**

Demonstrated understanding of the project objectives, operational requirements, and unique challenges associated with SETFA's facilities.

7. **Project Approach**

Quality and practicality of the firm's proposed approach to design, coordination, permitting, bidding, and construction administration.

8. **Capacity and Availability**

Ability to provide the necessary personnel, resources, and attention to successfully complete the anticipated work.

9. **Ability to Address Unique Requirements**

Demonstrated ability to accommodate needs that may be uncommon to the firm's prior projects but are specifically required by SETFA.

Following selection of the most qualified firm, SETFA intends to negotiate a professional services agreement in accordance with applicable Washington State requirements.

10. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS AND TIMELINE

The anticipated procurement schedule is as follows:

Activity	Date
RFQ Publication	September 14, 2026
Deadline for Submission of Qualifications	October 30, 2026, at 5:00 PM Pacific Time
Additional Information and/or Interviews	November 18, 2026
Notification of Selected Firm	November 20, 2026

SETFA reserves the right to modify this schedule as necessary.

13. TERMS AND CONDITIONS

13.1 Right to Reject

SETFA reserves the right to reject any or all Statements of Qualifications, in whole or in part, and to waive informalities or irregularities as permitted by applicable law.

13.2 Clarification and Additional Information

SETFA reserves the right to request clarification of information submitted and/or request additional information from any responding firm.



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13.3 Negotiations

SETFA reserves the right to negotiate a professional services agreement with the firm determined to be most highly qualified.

If SETFA and the selected firm are unable to successfully negotiate acceptable terms, including compensation, SETFA may terminate negotiations with the selected firm and initiate negotiations with the next most highly qualified firm, consistent with applicable law.

SETFA reserves the right to withhold award and/or cancel or re-solicit this RFQ if it determines such action to be in SETFA's best interest.

13.4 Costs

SETFA shall not be responsible for costs incurred by any firm in preparing, submitting, or presenting a response to this RFQ or in preparing for or participating in contract negotiations.

13.5 No Guarantee of Work

Issuance of this RFQ, selection of a firm, or execution of a professional services agreement shall not obligate SETFA to authorize or proceed with any particular project, phase, task, or expenditure.

Project scope, sequencing, schedule, and authorization will be subject to SETFA's needs, available funding, and applicable approvals.

14. EQUAL OPPORTUNITY EMPLOYMENT

The selected firm shall comply with applicable Washington State equal employment opportunity requirements.

SETFA is committed to equal employment opportunities without regard to race, color, creed, sex, national origin, disability, or other status protected by applicable law.



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15. TITLE VI

It is the policy of SETFA to assure that no person shall, on the grounds of race, color, national origin, or sex, as provided by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and applicable federal requirements, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or otherwise be subjected to discrimination under any federally funded program or activity administered by SETFA.

The selected firm and its subcontractors shall comply with all applicable Title VI and nondiscrimination requirements.

16. INSURANCE REQUIREMENTS

The selected firm and its subcontractors shall maintain insurance sufficient to protect the firm and SETFA against applicable risks associated with the professional services.

Insurance requirements shall be established in the professional services agreement and applicable standard insurance requirements for professional services contracts.

17. NON-ENDORSEMENT

As a result of selection to provide architectural and engineering services to SETFA, the selected firm agrees that it shall not use SETFA's name, logo, or other reference to SETFA in advertising, promotional materials, brochures, sales presentations, websites, or similar materials without the express written consent of SETFA.

18. NON-COLLUSION

By submitting a Statement of Qualifications, the submitting firm represents and warrants that its submission is genuine and has not been made in the interest of or on behalf of any undisclosed person, partnership, corporation, or other entity.

The submitting firm further represents that it has not directly or indirectly induced or solicited any other firm to submit a sham response, refrain from submitting a response, or otherwise participate in any collusive arrangement concerning this solicitation.



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19. COMPLIANCE WITH LAWS AND REGULATIONS

The selected firm shall comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, statutes, ordinances, regulations, and requirements relating to the performance of the professional services and any resulting contract.

Requirements may include, but are not limited to:

- Nondiscrimination and affirmative action requirements.
- Applicable licensing and professional registration requirements.
- Prevailing wage requirements, where applicable.
- Public and employee safety and health requirements.
- Environmental protection requirements.
- Waste reduction and recycling requirements.
- Protection of natural resources.
- Applicable permitting and building code requirements.
- Other requirements applicable to public works and public agency projects.

The selected firm shall be responsible for ensuring that its subcontractors and consultants comply with applicable requirements.

20. RESERVATION OF RIGHTS

SETFA reserves all rights available under applicable law, including the right to:

- Request clarification or additional information.
 - Conduct interviews.
 - Reject any or all submissions.
 - Cancel or reissue this solicitation.
 - Negotiate with the most highly qualified firm.
 - Negotiate with another qualified firm if negotiations with the first-ranked firm are unsuccessful.
 - Decline to award a contract.
 - Take any other action determined to be in SETFA's best interest and consistent with applicable law.
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21. CLOSING

Statements of Qualifications must be received no later than:

5:00 PM Pacific Time

October 30, 2026

Submissions shall be emailed to:

Fire Chief Mark King
SE Thurston Fire Authority
chief1@setfa.org

Email Subject:
QUALIFICATIONS AND QUOTATION FOR ARCHITECTURAL AND ENGINEERING SERVICES

Questions and requests for additional information shall also be directed to Fire Chief Mark King at chief1@setfa.org.